Simplifying Fractions

The final answer to a problem should be simplified, or written in lowest terms. A fraction is in lowest terms when there is no number that can evenly divide both the numerator and the denominator except for 1.

Example

Hide

Write $\frac{10}{15}$ in lowest terms.

Step 1

Think: What number can both 10 and 15 be divided by? Both can be divided by 5.

Step 2

Write 1 as a fraction using 5 as both the numerator and the denominator.

$1 = \frac{5}{5}$

Step 3

Divide $\frac{10}{15}$ by $\frac{5}{5}$.

$\frac{10}{15} \div \frac{5}{5} = \frac{10 \div 5}{15 \div 5} = \frac{2}{3}$

Step 4

Use cross products to check your work.

$\frac{10}{15} = \frac{2}{3}$

$15 \times 2 = 30$

$10 \times 3 = 30$

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Lesson 4: Fraction Basics

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